

Individual Instructor Report Spring 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05560) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2025**

Courses Audience: **56**

Responses Received: **48**

Response Ratio: **85.7%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

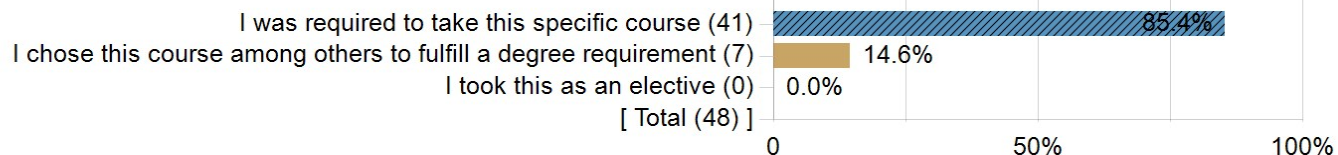
The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

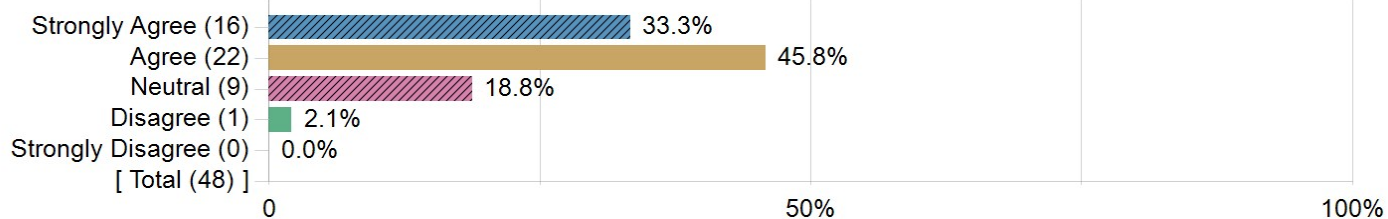
Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



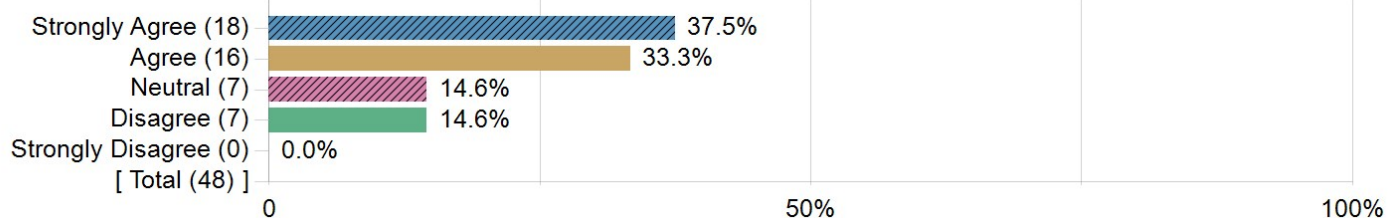
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.10

The course was well organized.



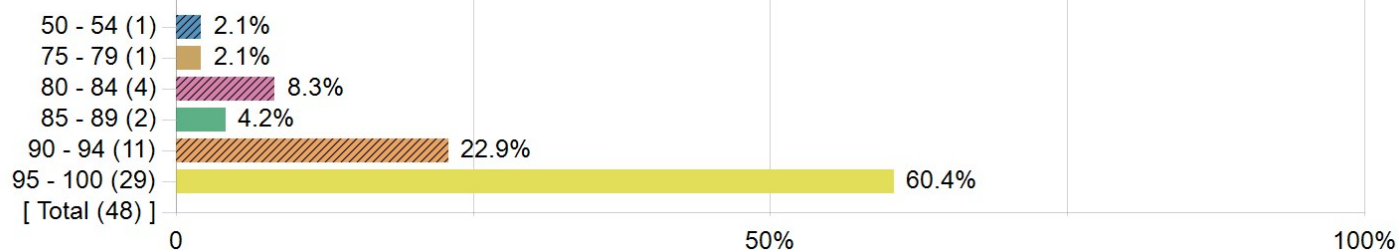
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.94

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



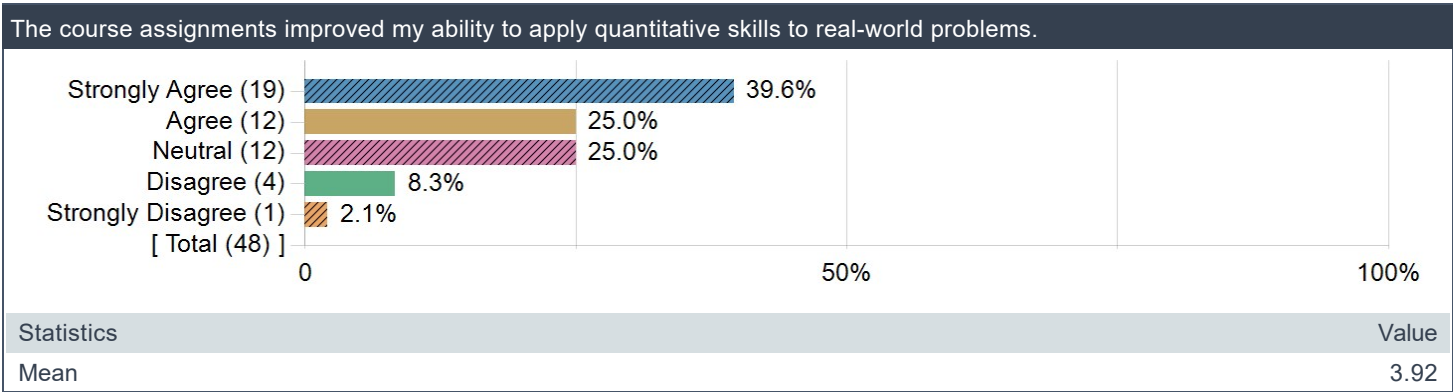
Statistics

Value

Mean

92.85

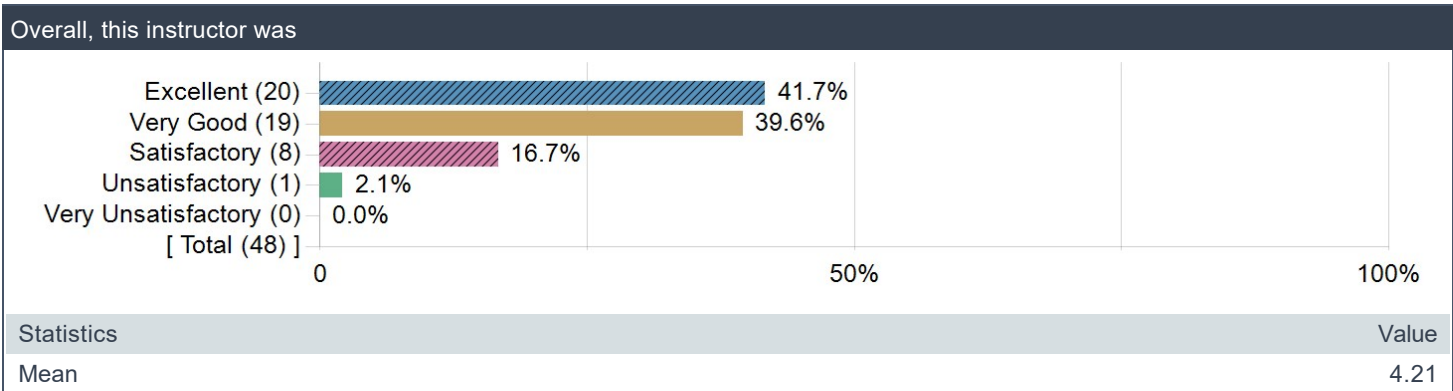
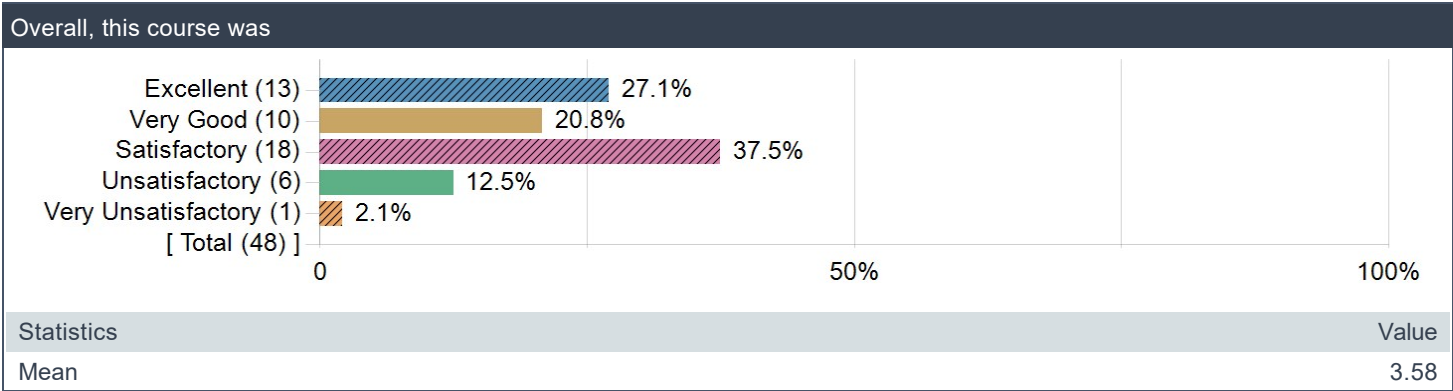
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



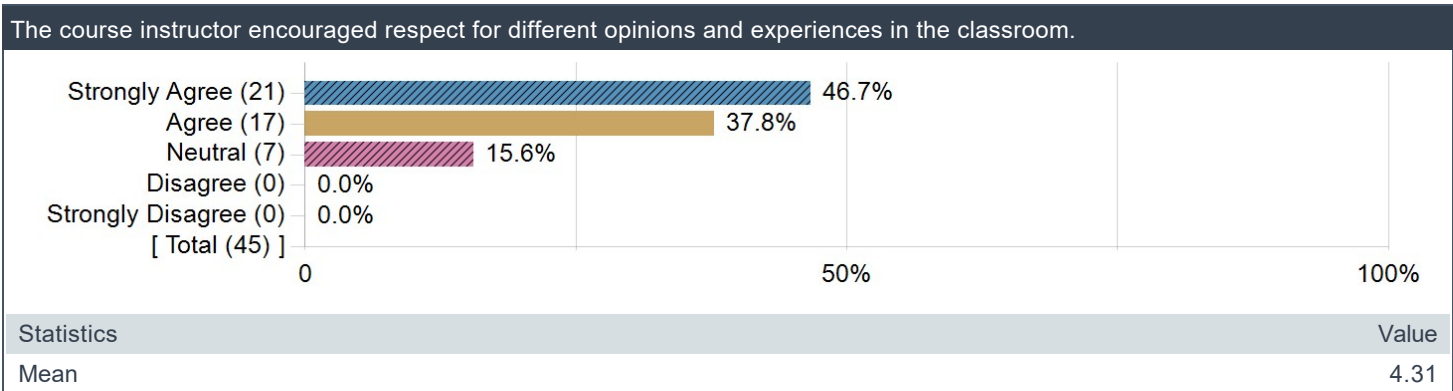
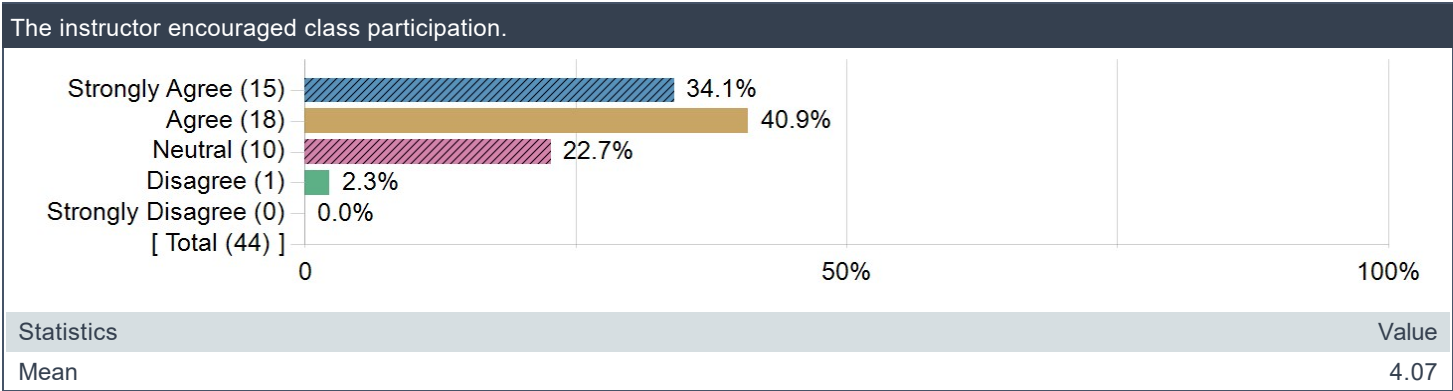
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	43.8%	39.6%	14.6%	2.1%	0.0%	48	4.25
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	52.1%	39.6%	8.3%	0.0%	0.0%	48	4.44
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	35.4%	43.8%	12.5%	8.3%	0.0%	48	4.06
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	27.1%	22.9%	25.0%	20.8%	4.2%	48	3.48
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	33.3%	52.1%	14.6%	0.0%	0.0%	48	4.19

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Step-by-step instructions
I think the homeworks and the checkpoint quizzes were very helpful to really emphasize the concepts we learned in previous classes.
I like how enthusiastic the professors were, and how helpful the TA's were
The examples we did in class were very helpful. I enjoyed the way he blocked the notes
He was so personable and made the class fun. I genuinely think he is such a precious human being.
I think that the most helpful parts of this course are outside of it. The TAs are great for helping have plenty of resources. Bolfarine is a kind professor as well.
The homework's, building on each attempt and having coding was very helpful.
lectures, and the homework
I really liked the lectures.
Lectures
Bolfarine was a very engaging lecturer and always kept things fun and lighthearted
The homework assignments were helpful
Humorous and understanding
he walked through all the code step by step which was very helpful
He goes into the topics taught with plenty of depth. This gives students the opportunity to take the course material as far as they want to.
Walking through code and opening the quizzes
Quizzes
I like the fact that he went through the r-script with us
The notes in rstudio in every class, and him explaining and showing everything
In class work throughs
The slides and online resources
The instructor explained concepts well and worked through problems in class to prepare students.
I thought the lectures were engaging and the practice exam helped prepare me for the real exam.
Office Hours! Dr. Bolfarine was incredibly helpful on a 1 on 1 scope and took the time to help me out.
The way to rewatch lectures helped out alot
The R scripts being completed and uploaded was helpful.
Doing the r-scripts in class
The weekly homeworks and in class quizzes forced me to learn.
Homeworks were very beneficial, as well as in-class walkthroughs. I was able to learn properly and apply it immediately for homework.
n/a
How every class was recorded, Prof. Bolfraine was really helpful in office hours, class was well organized, overall really great
Attending office hours was helpful to understand the questions I missed
Review sessions helped a lot, and practice exams were helpful.
I liked having paper tests that weren't centered on how well we could code but more so how much we understood what we were coding.
R Scripts
Going through the assignments with us in class and actually coding along with us
in class demonstrations and examples
He is a yapper but a good person
I say that the most effective were looking at the slides

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
I found Stats 235 and 301 to be classes that don't really build off of each other
I found some of the concepts that we went over a bit challenging. Something I would suggest future students to do is to set aside time to study for this class each week so they can build on their knowledge over its course.
All the R–studio stuff we did, in which felt like a waste of time since we never coded on exams.
The in class quizzes were the hardest part of the class. I think if they were more completion based that would be good because you can focus more on what you don't know with less consequences.
Some of the classes should have had recordings because he recorded each class but finding the recorded lectures was difficult.
I think that the most challenging part of this course is how fast–paced is, which I understand is a necessity for the class. I think that focusing on reading output instead of coding will help this class, especially considering the format of the exams. I think it can be made so so much clearer what the purpose of the course is, and teaching could be MUCH more engaging and concise.
We started with quizzes every class, which added a lot of stress and was not very directly correlated with what would be on the exam. I think they could make these less challenging and done with more time/help.
the quizzes were very tough for no reason
I found the quizzes to be challenging and I think having a 5 minute review at the beginning of class could help.
The course material, stats doesn't really click well with my brain.
The class was very slow–moving
I think one class a week is not enough for the second half of the semester. There is too much material and not enough time. One thing could be including a one hour discussion or something like that to finish material that wasn't covered rather than having to watch extra recordings.
Content itself could be difficult
Less content in the end, there is too much stuff sprung up at the end
The homework sets were much more difficult than the exams, which is a little bit weird. It makes it challenging to fully understand some of the material.
The content could be more organized and structured
Exams
The quizzes were lowkey hard and learning this stuff lowkey made no sense. I think the questions were too hard/specific to things we did not cover in class
Testing different than assignments
Quizzes without time to go over them
Quizzes there was not enough turn around time from learning the concept to taking them leading to unsatisfactory scores not because we could not learn the material but because there was no time to learn it in the short period of time
The in–class quizzes were sometimes challenging and asked questions that would not be found on future exams.
I thought the most challenging part was learning in R studio and then needing to understand the information on paper in more word problems.
The second half after spring break is where I started to get a little jaded. The lectures just got incredibly complex and slightly hard to pay attention to. Would reccomend class group work to engage students during class time.
Just the concept itself, but it isn't hard bc of the professor more so because the course is designed this way.
Sometimes the professor would drag on topics or ramble.
The quizzes they were so hard
I think Dr. Bolfarine's lectures were a bit confusing and sometimes felt unrelated to the assignments/course material. They sometimes were a bit rambling.
The daily class quizzes were the most challenging for me because I could not fully grasp the information in time to succeed on the quizzes, and I felt like I could never get 100s. I think it would be better to have walkthrough–quizzes rather than graded quizzes to prioritize learning and not grading.
n/a
The midterm test was challenging, maybe having a test that was similar to the structure of the midterm, I think it might just be difficult trying out a new format for the first time and could just be that it takes some getting used to
One of the things that was most challenging was the quizzes at the start of class.

Comments
Exam content piled up and was heavy workload to study.
I think staying engaged for the full two hours were extremely difficult especially when we went over time without a break.
Lectures were very long and hard to focus
The entire course material is very challenging, and one thing to be done to help future students meet this challenge more effectively is to go over the quizzes in class.
The in-class quizzes were most challenging having barely anytime to think and comprehend questions. I always entered class nervous and flustered. It was also frustrating that the quizzes are worth more than the time I spend on the weekly homeworks.
It's r.
The no break in between made me lose focus